VAYU | YOUR PERSONAL CROP GUIDE

Moringa (drumstick)

How to grow it on your land

Prepared for: General guide (no location chosen)
Prepared on 2026-11-09

Drought-tolerant, low capital, grows in poor soil and many climates. Income depends on a reliable buyer for pods or leaf.

DIFFICULTY	MONEY NEEDED	RISK	FIRST RETURN
2 of 5	**Low**	**Low**	**first pods about 6-8 months after planting for seed types such as PKM-1**

How to read this guide: [S1] marks a line backed by a source listed on the last page. (general knowledge) marks a line that has not been verified against a source. Lines starting **For your land** use the numbers for your location.

In this guide

- Your priorities: what to do first, in order
- Your planting plan: how much to buy and prepare for your plot
- How to grow it: planting, water, nutrition, pests and diseases, monitoring, harvest, risks
- If your conditions are different, and the sources behind every line

Your land at a glance

Your priorities

Ordered by what matters most on your land.

1. Talk to your KVK first
Take this guide to your nearest Krishi Vigyan Kendra and ask for their local advice and trusted planting material. (general knowledge)

2. Start small
Plant or build a small trial first. Learn the crop on your own land, then expand from what actually worked. (general knowledge)

3. Line up a buyer before you scale
Know who will buy, in what form and grade, and how it will reach them. (general knowledge)

Your planting plan for 1 acre

What	How much	Basis
Trees at 2.5 m x 2.5 m	**about 647**	your plot size x cited amounts [S1]
Compost or farmyard manure per pit	**9.7 tonnes**	your plot size x cited amounts [S1]
Seed (about 500 g per hectare)	**0.2 kg**	your plot size x cited amounts [S1]

Sums of the cited per-plant and per-hectare amounts for your plot size. Real needs vary with soil and variety; confirm with your KVK.

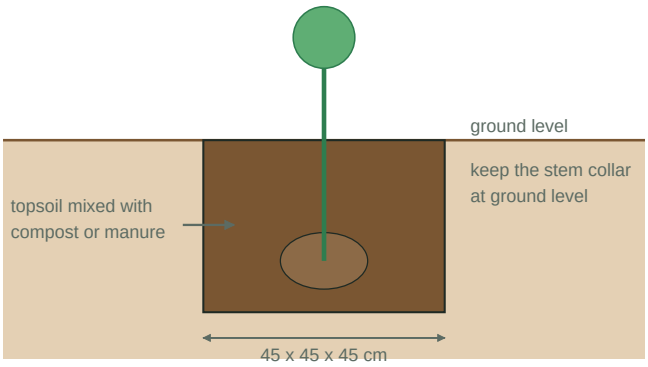
Planting material

- Annual types such as PKM-1 and PKM-2 (from TNAU) grow from seed; seed rate about 500 g per hectare. Sow two seeds per pit, or raise seedlings in polybags and transplant after 35-40 days. [S1]
- Get seed from a TNAU, ICAR or KVK source so you plant a known variety. (general knowledge)

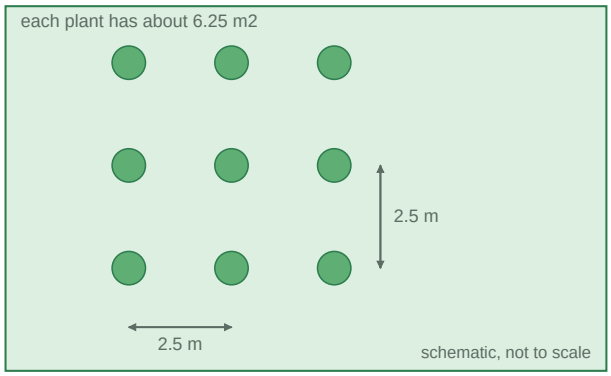
Land preparation and planting

- Planting season is July to October. Dig pits 45 x 45 x 45 cm at 2.0-2.5 m spacing and mix 15 kg compost or farmyard manure with topsoil in each pit. [S1]
- Closer spacing (for example 1.2 m x 1.2 m for PKM-2) is used for high-density plantings. [S1]

- Pinch the main shoot when seedlings are about 60-80 cm; repeat pinching during the first 3 months to get a bushy, easy-to-harvest tree. [S1, S7, S3]



Planting pit

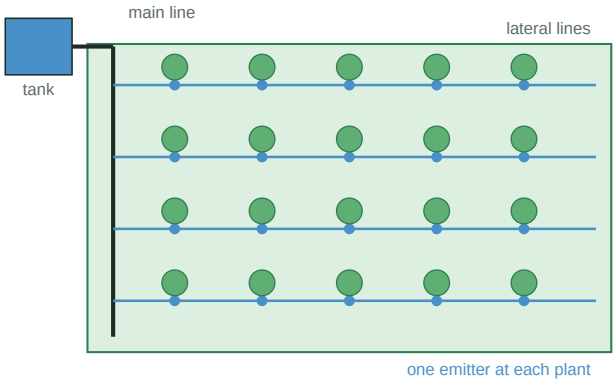


Plant spacing, top view

Irrigation

- Irrigate before sowing and on the 3rd day, then every 10-15 days depending on soil type. [S8]

- Avoid excess moisture; root rot follows waterlogging. [S3]



Drip irrigation layout (schematic)

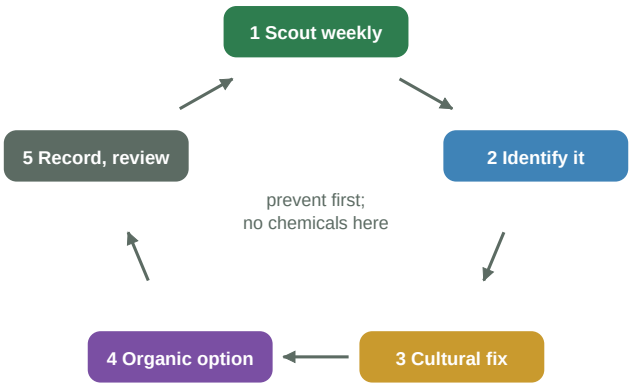
Nutrition (organic)

- Pit mix of farmyard manure or compost with a little neem cake; repeat compost each year. [S3]
- Mulch the base to conserve moisture. (general knowledge)

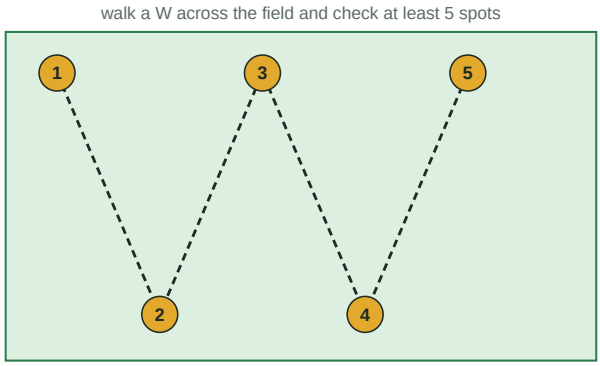
Pests and diseases (organic and cultural only)

- Main pests: leaf-eating caterpillars, bud worm, termite, aphid, leaf miner and fruit fly; root rot from excess moisture. [S3]
- Hang fermented tomato fruit traps (about 25 per hectare) for pod fly. [S8]
- Scout weekly, pick off caterpillars by hand, keep the field clean, and use neem-based preparations only as a spot treatment. (general knowledge)
- An official AESA-based IPM package for drumstick exists from NIPHM; ask your KVK for it. [S9]

- For anything beyond these organic and cultural steps, ask the nearest Krishi Vigyan Kendra (KVK) or state agricultural university for their current recommendation. (general knowledge)



Pest and disease loop: prevent first, then look, fix, review



How to walk the field when scouting

Monitoring

- Look under leaves and at growing tips weekly for caterpillars, aphids and leaf miner damage; check the trunk base for rot after rain. (general knowledge)
- Record flowering and pod set dates. (general knowledge)

Harvest, yield and post-harvest

- In a semi-arid western India trial, PKM-2 gave 44.3 kg of fruit per tree and PKM-1 36.7 kg. [S10]
- A KVK page gives an example of about Rs 1.25 lakh net income per acre per year at Rs 10/kg; treat this as one illustrative example with unstated assumptions, not a forecast. [S3]
- Pods are best sold fresh; line up a buyer or a nearby mandi before the first harvest. (general knowledge)

Risks and costs

- Pod prices swing with the season and glut periods; a few trees for home use plus a small commercial block is a lower-risk start. (general knowledge)
- Rainfall that is continuous gives near-continuous yield; dry spells can be bridged with irrigation. [S11]

If your conditions are different

What to do if your land, or the season, turns out different from the numbers above.

- **Cold weather** (fixable): It survives only light frost. In frost-prone areas protect young trees (cover, plant in a sheltered spot) or choose another crop. [S4]
- **Low rainfall** (fixable): Drought-tolerant, but flowering and yield improve with irrigation; use drip or basin irrigation in dry areas. [S2, S5]
- **Too much rain** (fixable): It will not survive prolonged flooding. On heavy rain or poor drainage, plant on mounds and keep water away from the trunk. [S6, S5]
- **Soil pH** (fixable): Tolerates a wide pH (5.0-9.0 reported) but best near neutral; add compost and get a soil test. [S6]

About chemicals

This guide gives organic and cultural methods only. It does not name or dose pesticides, fungicides or chemical fertilisers; for those, follow your nearest Krishi Vigyan Kendra (KVK) or state agricultural university and the label of any registered product.

Sources

[S1] https://agritech.tnau.ac.in/horticulture/horti_vegetables_annualmoringa.html
[S2] https://hortidata.blogspot.com/2023/01/production-technology-of-moringa.html
[S3] https://kvktumakuru2.icar.gov.in/?p=2261
[S4] https://www.slideshare.net/slideshow/moringa-cultivation/106906356
[S5] https://eagriorg.github.io/eagri50/HORT281/pdf/lec32.pdf
[S6] https://issuu.com/drumstickmoringa/docs/moringa_-suggested_ways_of_cultivat
[S7] https://www.slideshare.net/slideshow/moringa-cultivation/106906356
[S8] https://www.slideshare.net/SoudipNandi2/production-technology-for-vegetable-and-spices-drumstick-moringa
[S9] https://www.niphm.gov.in/IPMPackages/Drumstick.pdf
[S10] https://journal.iahs.org.in/index.php/ijh/article/download/1858/493
[S11] https://www.agrifarming.in/?p=805

Advisory aid from published sources and general agronomic knowledge, not a guarantee of yield or income and not a substitute for local extension advice. Lines marked 'general knowledge' are not verified against a source.